

Feeling

Serenity

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A mild, quiet ease settling over the experiencer.

A feeling of calm without effort — the absence of agitation. Serenity is close to the Umwelt because it asks little of the subject; it simply rests here, undemanding.

Positive · Feeling · Self-directed

Intensity: Mild (L1)

resonates with → Gratitude
deepens into → Contentment

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Feeling

Unease

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A faint disquiet — nothing named, nothing fixed, but something not quite right.

Unease is the mildest negative feeling. It lives near the Umwelt because it has not yet taken form, not yet crystallized into a defined emotion. It is the texture of a world that feels slightly off.

Negative · Feeling · Self-directed

Intensity: Mild (L1)

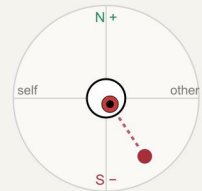
resonates with → Melancholy
deepens into → Sadness

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Emotion

Fear

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The body preparing for threat. A sharp contraction of possibility.

Fear is a high-intensity negative emotion — a primal organizing response. Far from the Umwelt because it hijacks attention and reconfigures the experiencer's entire field. In fear, nothing else is real except the threat.

Negative · Emotion · Other-directed

Intensity: Intense (L3)

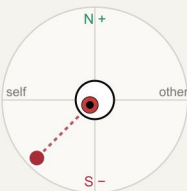
resonates with → Grief
becomes → Rage

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Feeling

Grief

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A shattering. The felt reality of irreversible loss.

Grief tears at the structure of the self. It sits far from the Umwelt because its gravity is large — it reorganizes the experiencer around an absence. The world is different now. That difference is felt.

Negative · Feeling · Self-directed

Intensity: Intense (L3)

intensifies into → Despair
resonates with → Fear

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Emotion

Hope

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A forward-leaning anticipation. The felt possibility of something better.

Hope is an emotion oriented toward a possible future. It sustains the experiencer through difficulty. Moderate intensity — strong enough to motivate, not so overwhelming as to consume. It reaches diagonally: ascending and outward.

Positive · Emotion · Other-directed

Intensity: Moderate (L2)

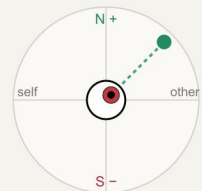
becomes → Excitement
resonates with → Relief

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Feeling

Joy

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A bright, expansive aliveness — a feeling that takes up space.

Joy is more consuming than contentment. It rises, fills the chest, pulls at the face. It sits farther from the Umwelt because its pull is strong — it reorganizes the subject around delight.

Positive · Feeling · Other-directed

Intensity: Intense (L3)

intensifies into → Bliss
resonates with → Excitement

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Feeling

Contentment

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A low hum of satisfaction. Things are sufficient; nothing is missing.

Contentment is a feeling of gentle fullness — not excitement, not striving. It sits close to the origin because it is not urgent or consuming. It deepens, given time, into joy.

Positive · Feeling · Self-directed

Intensity: Mild-Moderate (L2)

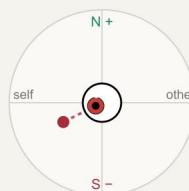
resonates with → Serenity
deepens into → Joy

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Feeling

Melancholy

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A wistful ache — beauty and sorrow woven together.

Melancholy is not pure grief. It carries a strange tenderness. It lingers near the Umwelt, threading through memory and longing. Neither fully painful nor fully sweet.

Negative · Feeling · Self-directed

Intensity: Mild-Moderate (L2)

resonates with → Sadness

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Emotion

Frustration

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A blocked force — energy with nowhere to go.

Frustration arises when action is impeded. It carries an arousal that cannot discharge, building pressure. Moderate distance reflects its growing urgency. It is not yet fear, not yet rage — but it is moving in that direction.

Negative · Emotion · Other-directed

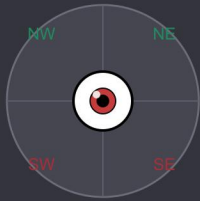
Intensity: Moderate (L2)

becomes → Fear
resonates with → Disappointment

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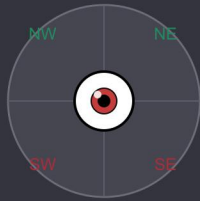
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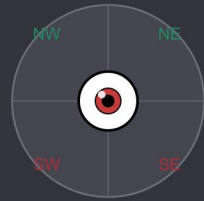
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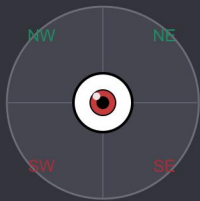
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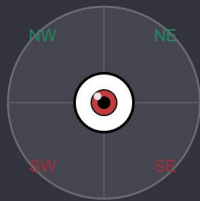
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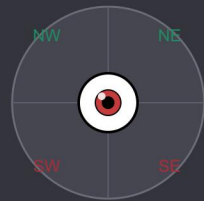
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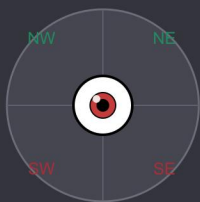
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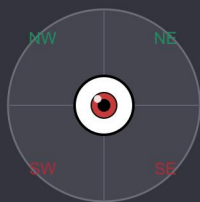
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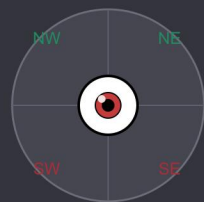
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Emotion

Excitement



An energized readiness — the world opening up.

Excitement is high-energy positive arousal. The experiencer leans toward what is coming. Its intensity is large enough to press outward from the umwelt — it is hard to contain, demanding expression.

Positive · Emotion · Other-directed

Intensity: Intense (L3)

resonates with → Joy
becomes → Ecstasy

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Disposition

Curiosity



A forward lean toward the unknown — a pull without demand.

Curiosity reaches outward more than it ascends: the longitude is extended, pointing toward what is not yet known. It enables exploration and is sustained by openness. Close enough to the umwelt to feel like a natural orientation, not an effort.

Positive · Disposition · Other-directed

Intensity: Moderate (L2–L3)

enables → To Explore
resonates with → Openness

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Disposition

Suspicion



A vigilance turned inward — reading the world for hidden threat.

Suspicion is a moderate negative disposition. The experiencer defaults to wariness. It contracts slightly rather than expanding. Functional in small doses; corrosive when it becomes the default frame.

Negative · Disposition · Self-directed

Intensity: Moderate (L2)

resonates with → Indifference

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Disposition

Compassion



A felt orientation toward the suffering of another — moved to care.

Compassion is a strong disposition: it requires real capacity from the experiencer. Its distance from the umwelt reflects the effort and vulnerability involved in genuine care. It enables the intent to nurture.

Positive · Disposition · Other-directed

Intensity: Intense (L3–L4)

enables → To Nurture
resonates with → Generosity

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Disposition

Equanimity



A stable, non-reactive inner steadiness in the face of whatever comes.

Equanimity does not resist joy or sorrow — it holds both without being overturned by either. Further from the umwelt than serenity because it is a hard-won achievement rather than a passive state. Enabled by self-compassion; it is what self-compassion builds toward at scale.

Positive · Disposition · Self-directed

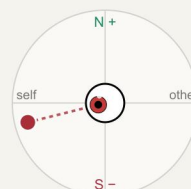
Intensity: Intense (L3)

resonates with → Serenity

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Disposition

Indifference



An absence of orientation — the world does not call to the experiencer.

Indifference extends far in longitude away from the self — the experiencer simply does not reach toward things. Low in latitude: it does not descend violently, it simply flattens. A deadening, not a crisis. It enables withdrawal.

Negative · Disposition · Self-directed

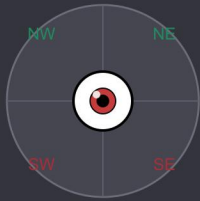
Intensity: Moderate (L2–L3)

resonates with → Suspicion
enables → To Withdraw

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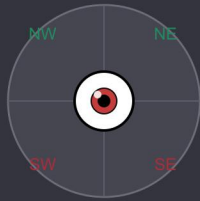
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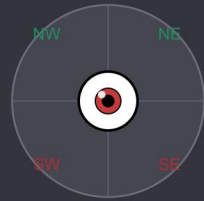
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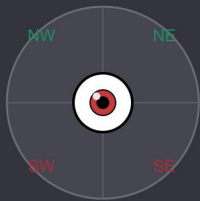
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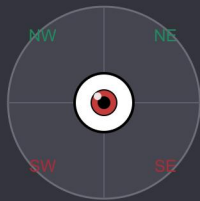
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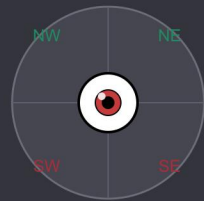
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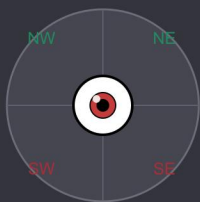
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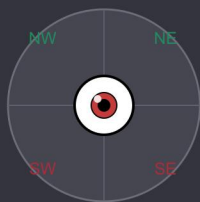
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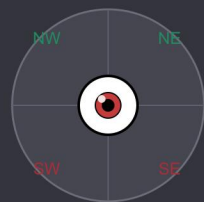
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